

Primarily this is because rulers of the exchange of mankind's goods have failed through their own stubbornness and their own incompetence, have admitted their failure, and have abdicated. Practices of the unscrupulous money changers stand indicted in the court of public opinion, rejected by the hearts and minds of men.

True they have tried, but their efforts have been cast in the pattern of an outworn tradition. Faced by failure of credit they have proposed only the lending of more money. Stripped of the lure of profit by which to induce our people to follow their false leadership, they have resorted to exhortations, pleading tearfully for restored confidence. They know only the rules of a generation of self-seekers. They have no vision, and when there is no vision the people perish.

The money changers have fled from their high seats in the temple of our civilization. We may now restore that temple to the ancient truths. The measure of the restoration lies in the extent to which we apply social values more noble than mere monetary profit.⁷

While Roosevelt's judgment is understandable, market realities show that speculation has its place in the investment world. Speculators often jump on opportunities more quickly than does a typical investor, which begins the process of pricing new information into the value of an asset. In seeking to profit from opportunity, speculators help drive the search between buyers and sellers for a mutually agreed upon price. When a shortage of an asset is on the horizon, whether it be energy commodities or electronic hardware, speculators will quickly bid up the price of that good. As a result, more suppliers are drawn to the market, accelerating the alleviation of the shortage in classic supply and demand economics.

When it comes to innovation, such as the introduction of railroads, automobiles, or the Internet, speculation served to allocate money to the rapid buildout of the infrastructures